

mini-Bangladesh soon ("Going for the Kill", July 14). The Government needs to take stringent measures to curb this influx. However, it is dirty vote bank politics of the leaders which is acting as an obstacle. The Government would rather focus on political gains than cleanse the state of migrants.

A. SRIKANTIAH, *Bangalore*

Power Trip

Gurjar leader Colonel Kirori Singh Bainsla's salute to Rajasthan Chief Minister Vasundhara Raje is not a sign of her victory but a symbol of defeat ("Salute to Success", June 30). By conceding to Gurjar's demands, Raje has sent out a wrong message: violence can be a means to attain political gains.

BIDYUT KUMAR CHATTERJEE,
on e-mail

Referred and Deferred

It is true that the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) has become nothing less than a fire-fighting squad ("Dial C for CBI", July 21). Referring frivolous matters to the CBI will undermine public's confidence in the police force. It might come in handy to dodge public ire and earn political brownie points, but how long? The police can very well do what CBI is entrusted to do—conduct free and fair investigation of the crime. So why not let the police do their job and not burden the CBI?

ROHIT KUMAR, *Mumbai*

The agency can bring to book anyone who is a small fry or does not enjoy any clout in the corridors of

power or has lost favours recently. The cases of Aarushi, Scarlett and Rajbir don't involve any political heavyweight. The agency's credentials will come to test if it does something worthwhile to bring the accused, who enjoy political clout, behind bars.

NUTAN THAKUR, *on e-mail*

Arms Muddle

Notwithstanding the qualification or the price of the Dhruv helicopter, the decision taken by Chile in the

matter was based on technical grounds and according to the specific needs of the Chilean armed forces ("South American Surprise, July 14"). Attributing the decision of the Chilean Army to "political arm-twisting" reveals a narrow view on the issue, for competitive prices over technical evaluation is not the prevailing rule in such purchases.

SEBASTIAN MOLINA,
Second Secretary, Press
Department, Embassy of Chile

TERROR CAULDRON



The deadly terror attack on the Indian Embassy in Kabul is clearly the most chilling instance of the severe hostility India faces from a Talibanised Afghanistan and its jittery Pakistani sponsors ("Why India is the New Target", July 21). Ever since India took a conscious decision, and rightly so, to assist the Government of President Hamid Karzai in rebuilding Afghanistan, destroyed by civil war and Taliban depredation, with the strategic objective of stabilising the country, there has been disquiet on two fronts: The Pakistani establishment and its natural ally, the Al Qaeda-backed Taliban. But come what may, we should not be deterred, and continue the peace-keeping measures.

K.S. JAYATHEERTHA, *Bangalore*

The ghastly attack was aimed at destabilising the rebuilding process in Afghanistan. India and Afghanistan should step up the security measures to prevent such attacks.

VIRENDRA KUMAR TANGRI, *on e-mail*

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Testing Time

The acid test for Chief Minister Sharad Pawar arrived sooner than expected. He had barely moved into his spacious Mantralaya office when Marathwada erupted. July 26's minor stone-throwing incident in Aurangabad had exploded into an orgy of violence between warring Hindus and Harijans, leaving many dead, Government property damaged and rail and postal communications paralysed.



There had been simmering discontent among Hindu students in Aurangabad ever since both Houses of the Maharashtra legislature recommended that the name of Marathwada University be changed to Dr Babasaheb Ambedkar University. For Pawar, the agitation could not have come at a worse time—he was still juggling with Cabinet portfolio allocations and neutralising the influence of the various factions in his coalition Government.

—Minhaz Merchant